03-16 第1篇

阅读理解（说明文） How the Great Wall Was Built

① When foreign visitors first see the Great Wall near Beijing, many of them say the same sentence: "It looks like a sleeping dragon on the mountains." They often ask one question too: **how could old China build such a long wall, with no trucks, no machines, and no wifi?** The answer is not one clever trick, but many small ideas that grew over **more than 2,000 years**.

② The first walls were not a single long line. As early as the **7th century BC**, several small kingdoms built short walls of earth to protect their fields from horse riders in the north. Later, in **221 BC**, Emperor Qin Shi Huang connected these old walls into one longer wall. The wall we can walk on today, however, was mostly built much later, during the **Ming Dynasty (1368 — 1644)**, when stronger bricks and stones were used.

③ How did workers carry all those bricks up such high mountains? In many places, they did not carry them directly. A clever idea was to use **goats and donkeys**: workers tied a few bricks to each animal's back, and the animals walked up narrow stone paths that humans could barely climb. For very steep parts, workers made a **simple rope pulley** with a wooden wheel. One man could lift a heavy brick by pulling a rope down instead of walking up with it.

④ Another secret is the **strong "glue"** between the stones. In the Ming Dynasty, builders mixed lime, sand, and **sticky rice juice** into a kind of soft paste. When it dried, it became harder than many modern cements. This is one reason the Great Wall has stood for hundreds of years. Some modern tests found that small pieces of this old "rice glue" were still hard after **500 years** of wind and snow.

⑤ The wall was not only a tall line of stones. Along the wall, every few hundred metres, stood a small **watch tower**. Soldiers lived inside and watched the hills day and night. If they saw enemies coming, they lit a fire at the top of the tower. A second tower farther away would see the smoke and also light a fire. In this way, a simple fire signal could travel **hundreds of kilometres** in just a few hours — far faster than any horse at that time.

⑥ So, the Great Wall is more than bricks and mountains. It is the record of many small and patient ideas: short walls becoming long, animals becoming carriers, sticky rice becoming glue, and fire becoming a message. Each idea was small, but put together, they built a shape so huge that a modern astronaut, flying hundreds of kilometres above, can still feel its quiet, winding line on the dark green hills.

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. When did Emperor Qin Shi Huang connect the small old walls into one long wall?

A. 221 BC.
B. 1368 AD.
C. 500 AD.
D. 1644 AD.

2. How did workers carry bricks up steep mountain paths?

A. They used big trucks and lifts.
B. They tied bricks to goats and donkeys and used simple rope pulleys.
C. They threw the bricks from the top of the hills.
D. They carried the bricks inside their pockets.

3. What was added to the lime and sand to make the Ming Dynasty "glue"?

A. Sea water.
B. Egg yolk.
C. Sticky rice juice.
D. Soy sauce.

4. Why were fires lit on the watch towers?

A. To keep soldiers warm during cold nights.
B. To cook food for passing travellers.
C. To send a fast signal when enemies were coming.
D. To scare away wild animals.

5. What is the main idea of the passage?

A. The Great Wall is only famous because it is near Beijing.
B. The Great Wall was built quickly in one single year.
C. The Great Wall is the result of many small, patient ideas over a long time.
D. The Great Wall has no real use today.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "in 221 BC, Emperor Qin Shi Huang connected these old walls"
【解析】原文明确。其他年份属他事。故选 A。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "goats and donkeys... simple rope pulley"
【解析】借助山羊、驴与简易滑轮。A、C、D 与原文不符。故选 B。

3.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段 "mixed lime, sand, and sticky rice juice"
【解析】加入糯米汁。A、B、D 无依据。故选 C。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段 "a simple fire signal could travel hundreds of kilometres"
【解析】烽火用于快速传递敌情信号。A、B、D 无依据。故选 C。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑥段 "the record of many small and patient ideas"
【解析】全文主旨是"众多小巧耐心的智慧累积成长城"。A、B、D 均偏题或与文意相反。故选 C。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **pulley** [n.] 滑轮
- **lime** [n.] 石灰
- **dynasty** [n.] 朝代